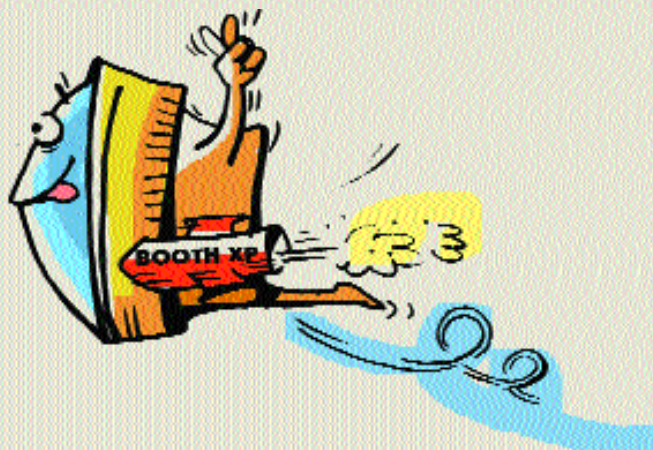


...because your RAM doesn't oblige XP's bells and whistles



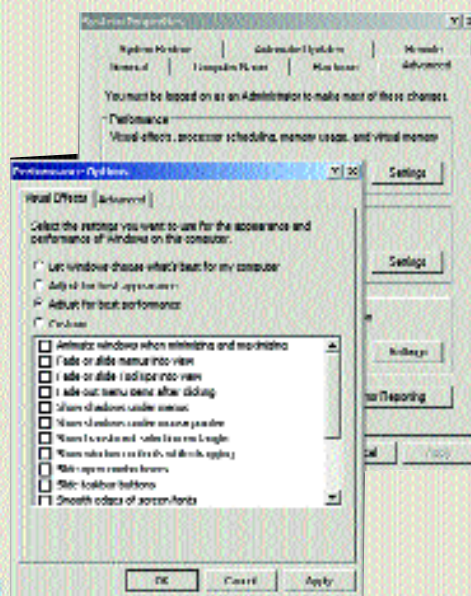
When installing Windows XP, make a clean install, as opposed to updating from an older version. This is because formatting your hard drive to use the NTFS file system is better, since FAT32 is slower and less stable. To change your drive's FAT32 file system to NTFS, go to **Start > Run** and type '**command**'. At the command prompt, type '**convert X: /FS:NTFS**' and press **[Enter]**—here '**X**' is the drive you want to convert.

What you should look to improve upon is bootup time. You can save as much as 30 seconds by optimising your boot options. If only one person uses your computer, leave the password blank. Also disable Fast User Switching by going to **Start > Run**, and typing **'control userpasswords'** and pressing **[Enter]**.

❗ Prettier equals slower

The first thing you notice in XP is the look. Unfortunately, the crisp menus, the new fade-in and fade-out effects and the breathtaking wallpapers drain your system's memory. For any PC with less than 256 MB of RAM and a CPU slower than 1 GHz, turn off all the frills.

The easiest way to do this is to press **[Windows] + [Pause/Break]** to launch the System Properties dialog box. Here, click on Advanced. You'll see three 'Settings' buttons. Click the one related to

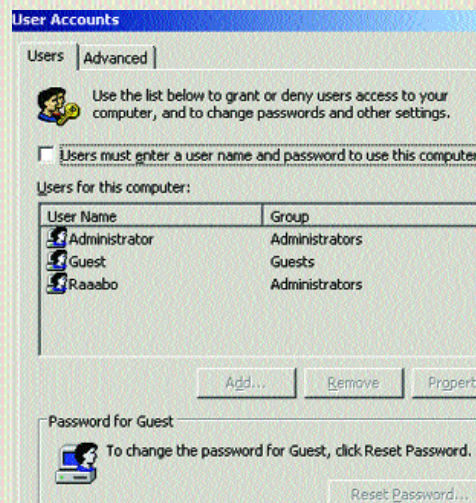


From within the System Properties dialog box, you can set Windows XP to give preference to performance. You can allocate its resources to give preference to the programs you run

'Performance'. The dialog box called Performance Options pops up. Under Visual Effects, select 'Adjust for best performance' and click Apply.

Again, in the Performance Options dialog box, click on Advanced. Under Processor scheduling and Memory usage, make sure the Programs option is selected in each case.

To disable logon passwords entirely, go to **Start > Run**, type **'control userpassword2'** and



If you have only one user on your computer, it makes sense to disable password requirements

